session_store = :file_store

Session data is stored in flat files. It's pretty much useless for Rails applications because the contents must be strings. This mechanism supports the additional configuration options `:prefix`, `:suffix`, and `:tmpdir`.

Comparing Session Storage Options

With all these session options to choose from, which should you use in your application? As always, the answer is "it depends."

When it comes to performance, there are few absolutes, and everyone's context is different. Your hardware, network latencies, database choices, and possibly even the weather will impact how all the components of session storage interact. Our best advice is to start with the simplest workable solution and then monitor it. If it starts to slow you down, find out why before jumping out of the frying pan.

If you have a high-volume site, keeping the size of the session data small and going with `cookie_store` is the way to go.

If we rule out memory store as being too simplistic, file store as too restrictive, and `memcached` as overkill, the server-side choices boil down to CookieStore, Active Record store, and DRb-based storage. Should you need to store more in a session than you can with cookies, we recommend you start with an Active Record solution. If, as your application grows, you find this becoming a bottleneck, you can migrate to a DRb-based solution.

Session Expiry and Cleanup

One problem with all the server-side session storage solutions is that each new session adds something to the session store. This means you'll eventually need to do some housekeeping or you'll run out of server resources.

Another reason to tidy up sessions is that many applications don't want a session to last forever. Once a user has logged in from a particular browser,